

collaborates with academic and defence institutions such as DRDO, IISc, IITs, and international partners, supporting research in power electronics, communication resilience, and additive manufacturing. These partnerships enable the development of drones capable of operating in GPS-denied or high-interference environments.

BonV Aero's drones are already in active service with the Indian Army, and pre-orders for additional units are underway. The company operates a small-scale manufacturing facility in Bhubaneswar and

has secured land for a larger Drone Mobility Park to support future production and testing. Funding has come from a mix of government initiatives, private investors, and venture capitalists, including Tim Draper, making BonV Aero one of the few homegrown aviation start-ups with international backing.

Government reforms, such as the reduction of GST on drones and the introduction of the Drone Policy 2021, have also facilitated growth by simplifying approvals and reducing production costs. BonV Aero sees itself as part of a broader vision to

establish India as a hub for aerial mobility innovation.

Over the next five years, the company aims to expand its role in defence and commercial aerial mobility, with plans for transport-class drones capable of carrying passengers over short distances. Its goal is to combine cutting-edge technology, operational reliability, and scalable manufacturing to deliver drones that can address both strategic and civilian challenges, from high-altitude logistics to disaster relief and urban mobility.

—Vidushi Saxena

2 WHY WEAR A MASK WHEN YOU CAN WEAR AN AIR PURIFIER?

Struggling with pollution? Ordinary masks are not enough. Atovio, an Indian startup, is making wearable air purifiers that turn polluted air into your personal clean zone.

Anmay Shahlot, co-founder of Atovio and a graduate of IIM Indore, was working in a consulting firm in Gurugram. Life was comfortable, but the city's air quality was a constant concern. Masks and room purifiers were insufficient. That was when he thought of making a personal air purifier. His friends Siddharth and Aditi joined him on his journey.

They named their company Atovio to reflect what they believe in. The name comes from combining two words, 'atmosphere' and 'Vayu.' 'Ato' comes from atmosphere, and 'vio' comes from Vayu. When building the product, their first goal was to make it effective. So, the team designed a product that could be worn easily for up to 12 hours a day, balancing comfort, effectiveness, and affordability. Their goal was simple: to make clean air protection practical for everyday use.

Everyone has seen air purifiers, but this one stands out for its size and personalisation. Anmay says, "This is a very Indian innovation



Atovio Pebble: Wearable air purifier

because no other country faces air quality levels above 200AQI like India does. Our device is the only one tested and designed specifically for Indian pollution conditions. We even have a design patent for this product, which lets us confidently make these claims in public forums."

The technology behind the device is different from standard room air purifiers, which use a HEPA filter and a fan to capture pollutants. "We use advanced variable anion technology, releasing around six million negative ions into the air. These ions attach to pollutants in the user's breathing space, making them heavy and causing them to settle.

Because of this, the device has no fan, no filter, and requires almost no maintenance," Anmay adds.

The wearable purifier has been rigorously tested at India's leading air quality lab, the National Aerosol Facility at IIT Kanpur. Tests were conducted in a space of about 35 cubic feet (approx. one cubic metre),